THE BULLOCK PRESIDENCY

Series Bible — Document 02: The Catastrophic Event (Proposed Canon)

1. The Event: "THE UNSHIELDING"

Scientific name in-story: the Rapid Geomagnetic Excursion Event (RGEE). **What the public calls it: The Unshielding**. **Internet nicknames:** "The Naked Sky," #SkyFall, "Day Zero."

One-line pitch: Earth's magnetic field, the invisible shield that has protected every human civilization in history, collapses faster than any scientist thought possible. Then, while the planet has no shield, the Sun strikes.

What happens

- **The Weakening.** The planet's magnetic field starts losing strength at an unprecedented rate. Weak spots that scientists already monitor in real life (the South Atlantic Anomaly) spread and multiply. Compasses drift, satellites glitch, and animals migrate the wrong way.
- **The Strike, "Day Zero."** A powerful solar storm hits the weakened Earth. In 1859 a storm like this (the Carrington Event) only sparked telegraph lines. In 2032, with almost no shield, it takes down power grids on whole continents in minutes, along with satellites, GPS, communications, and the internet backbone.
- **The Long Exposure.** The shield doesn't come back. For years, more cosmic and solar radiation reaches the ground. Aviation is grounded or restricted, the ozone layer thins, UV levels rise, crops and the food supply come under stress, and every later solar flare becomes a national emergency.

2. Why It Is "Never Before Seen" and 1000x More Terrifying

- **No human civilization has ever lived through one.** The last full excursion (the Laschamp event) happened about 41,000 years ago. There is no playbook, no precedent, and no expert who has seen it.
- **In-story it is faster than any model predicted.** Real excursions are believed to unfold over centuries. Ours plays out in a few years, and that speed is the core mystery and the core horror. (This is our deliberate creative license, and in-story scientists are as shocked as everyone else.)
- **There is no enemy.** You can't negotiate with it, sanction it, bomb it, or arrest it. Every normal political tool is useless.
- **It is invisible and silent.** No explosion and no mushroom cloud. Just beautiful auroras over Miami, Mexico City, and Cairo the night the lights go out. The beauty is what makes it terrifying.
- **It hits everyone at once.** Every country is a victim at the same moment, so nobody can send help. Rivals see opportunity in the chaos.
- **There is no end date.** Hurricanes pass and wars end. The shield's recovery could take years or decades, and nobody can tell the public when it will be over.
- **It attacks modern life itself.** Electricity, phones, banking, water pumps, hospitals, fuel, refrigeration, and elections all depend on the systems it destroys.

- **The worst is still ahead.** Day Zero comes near solar minimum, when cosmic radiation is highest. Solar Cycle 26 is expected to peak around 2034–2036, so the most violent solar storms will hit an unshielded Earth during the *next* term. That is the heart of why the country won't change leaders.

3. First Term or Second Term?

Recommendation: SECOND TERM, specifically the final months, with warning signs planted during the first term.

Factor	First term	Second term (recommended)
Reason to stay past two terms	Weak. He would simply win a normal re-election in 2028, and the crisis peaks too early to matter in 2032.	Strong. The disaster lands as his time legally runs out, and the worst lies ahead.
Dramatic irony	Low	High. A term-limited lame duck suddenly becomes the most essential person in the country.
Constitutional drama	None needed	The 22nd Amendment fight becomes the climax of the saga.
Continuity payoff	Little setup time	Seven-plus years of seeded clues pay off.
Character test	He is still new	He is tired and has made enemies, and now he faces the hardest test of his life.

4. Proposed Event Timeline

Date	Phase	What happens
Term 1 (2025–2028)	Seeds	Small stories that look like B-plots: a NOAA scientist's ignored warning, a satellite failure, a brief GPS outage, an odd aurora sighting. Bullock asks one quiet question and funds one obscure program. This pays off years later.
Sat Jan 20, 2029	Term 2 begins	Second inauguration at noon ET on the Capitol steps. (Jan 20 falls on a Saturday, so the public ceremony stays that day, as in 2001.)
2029–2031	The Weakening	Field-strength data accelerates. Scientists argue, cable news debates it, and the internet calls it a hoax or the apocalypse. Opponents call it fearmongering. Insurance and markets react.
Mid-2032	Warnings	The scientific consensus flips to alarm. Bullock is now term-limited, and both parties are deep in the 2032 campaign.
Mon Sep 13, 2032	**DAY ZERO**	The Strike, 50 days before Election Day. The grid fails across much of North America, Europe, and Asia. The scene runs minute by minute through the White House, ordinary homes, hospitals, a 747 in flight, and a social media feed that cuts out mid-post.
Sep–Oct 2032	The Dark Weeks	National emergency, partial restoration, rationing, unrest, foreign opportunism, and conspiracy theories. Bullock's handling becomes the defining test of his presidency.
Tue Nov 2, 2032	The Election Crisis	With power, mail, and voting systems crippled in many states, the election becomes a constitutional emergency: postponement or a broken vote.
Late 2032–2033	The Amendment Fight	Congress debates suspending or repealing the 22nd Amendment for the emergency. Real precedent: the 26th Amendment was ratified in about 100 days in 1971.
Thu Jan 20, 2033	The Deadline	Noon ET is the 20th Amendment's hard constitutional deadline, and the countdown clock drives the climax.

Date	Phase	What happens
2033–2036+	The Long Exposure	Bullock's third term (and possibly more) runs into the peak of Solar Cycle 26.

5. Path to More Than Two Terms (Options for the Author)

- **Option A, the Continuity Amendment (recommended):** Congress passes, and the states ratify in record time, an amendment suspending the 22nd Amendment during a declared existential emergency. Bullock then wins a delayed, emergency election. It is the most realistic and most democratic route, and it gives the opposition a legitimate, full-strength cause to fight.
- **Option B, full repeal:** the 22nd Amendment is repealed outright. A bigger, more controversial swing with long-term consequences.
- **Option C, the succession gambit:** the election fails, and a constitutional chain of events puts Bullock back in office by another route. Darker and more legally knotty, and it hands his enemies the line "he's a dictator."
- Whatever you pick, the opposition is not nerfed. Serious figures argue in good faith that suspending term limits is exactly how republics die, and that argument stays alive inside the story.

6. Sample Day Zero Headlines and Posts

> *BREAKING (AP, 9:14 PM EDT): Massive geomagnetic storm triggers widespread power outages across U.S., Canada, Europe*
>
> *@NWSSWPC: G5 EXTREME geomagnetic storm in progress. Conditions exceed all historical scales.*
>
> *@random_user: why is the sky green in Tampa rn*
>
> *@random_user: is anyone else's phone saying no ser*
>
> *NEW YORK TIMES (print edition, Sep 15, 2032, printed on generator power): "THE NIGHT THE SHIELD FAILED"*

7. Writing Guardrails

- The science is grounded and rendered dramatically. Real agencies (NOAA's Space Weather Prediction Center, NASA, USGS, FEMA, NERC) and real concepts appear, with the speed of the excursion as our one deliberate liberty.
- The disaster shows up through people: a dialysis patient, a lineman, an astronaut on the ISS, a farmer, a newsroom on generator power, a family in the dark.
- It is depicted at TV-MA intensity. Real losses and real deaths matter and carry forward in continuity.